ACTIVITY 13 – GLOBAL TECH AMBASSADOR & OPEN-SOURCE PATHWAY SELECTION

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Part A – Program Comparison

The two programs selected are **Microsoft Student Ambassadors (MSA)** and **GitHub Campus Experts** because they align with my interests in AI/ML, software development, GitHub/open source, community learning, and professional growth.

Criteria	Microsoft Student Ambassadors	GitHub Campus Experts
Main focus	Microsoft technology, AI learning, community building and leadership	Building technical communities, Git/GitHub and open-source culture
Eligibility / requirements	Current Microsoft information describes the program as open to students from all backgrounds and emphasizes learning Microsoft technologies, community participation and leadership.	Must be 18+, enrolled in formal higher education, have used GitHub for at least 6 months, have more than one year remaining before graduation, and validate student status through the GitHub Student Developer Pack.
Application cycle	Current Microsoft Student Ambassador information states that getting started does not require an application or gatekeeping; students can join the student community and develop skills through the program.	Applications open every **July for one month**. The process includes an application and, after the initial stage, a video resume.
Key benefits	Practical technology skills, leadership development, connections with peers, mentors and Microsoft employees, plus opportunities such as immersive rotations.	Training, mentorship and support for building technical communities; opportunities to organize workshops, meetups,

Criteria	Microsoft Student Ambassadors	GitHub Campus Experts
		hackathons and other learning activities.
My current fit	Strong interest in AI/ML and technology communication; Microsoft/GitHub/VS Code experience provides a foundation. Cloud/Azure knowledge needs improvement.	Strong GitHub foundation with 13 public repositories, README documentation and Git experience; Student Developer Pack verification still needs to be confirmed.

Note: Program information and application procedures can change. The current official sources should be checked again before applying.

Part B – Self-Assessment and Gap Analysis

Current strengths

- 6–12 months of GitHub experience with **13 public repositories**.
- Experience creating project README files, GitHub profile documentation and Markdown documentation.
- Experience with C, C++, Python, DSA, SQL/MySQL, GitHub, AI/ML, backend development and HTML/CSS.
- Projects include a **Smart Hydration Patch**, personal portfolio website, C/C++ mini projects and LeetCode solutions.
- Participated in **Smart India Hackathon** as a team member with backend-development responsibility.
- Participated in HackerRank coding activities.
- Technical writing experience through README files, project documentation, LeetCode documentation and LinkedIn posts.
- Interested in creating technical tutorials and AI/ML learning content.

Main gaps identified

Gap	Current status	Improvement required
Open source	Some GitHub/PR experience, but limited contribution history	Make regular contributions to established projects
Pull Requests	Has PR experience but needs greater consistency	Submit useful, documented PRs
AI/ML	General knowledge but limited project portfolio	Build at least one practical AI/ML project
Cloud/Azure	Limited experience	Complete beginner Azure/Microsoft learning content
Public speaking	Needs development	Conduct or participate in technical sessions
Community leadership	Limited formal leadership experience	Organize a small technical learning activity
Professional projects	Portfolio exists but needs stronger project depth	Improve documentation, demos and project outcomes
Resume/LinkedIn	Needs further strengthening	Update projects, achievements and technical skills

4-Week Preparation Roadmap

Week 1 – Profile Foundation

- Verify GitHub Student Developer Pack eligibility.
- Improve GitHub profile README and important repository READMEs.
- Organize repositories and remove incomplete/unnecessary content.
- Begin structured AI/ML learning.
- Review Microsoft/Azure fundamentals.

Week 2 – Open Source + AI/ML

- Identify beginner-friendly open-source repositories.
- Study contribution guidelines and issue/PR workflow.
- Make or improve an open-source contribution.
- Start a small AI/ML project and publish its initial documentation.
- Write one technical tutorial.

Week 3 – Community & Communication

- Prepare a short AI/ML or Git/GitHub workshop for classmates.
- Practice a 5–10 minute technical presentation.
- Publish AI/ML learning content or a technical post.
- Improve LinkedIn and resume project descriptions.

Week 4 – Application Preparation

- Finalize GitHub profile and strongest repositories.
- Document open-source contributions and project outcomes.
- Prepare answers about motivation, community impact and future goals.
- Record/practice a short video introduction for GitHub Campus Experts.
- Review Microsoft and GitHub program requirements immediately before applying.

Available preparation time: 6–8 hours/week, with AI/ML as the primary focus.

Part C – Drafted Application Response

Technical Community Motivation Essay

I want to become a technology ambassador because I believe technology should be approachable, practical, and empowering rather than something that feels limited to experienced developers and engineers. As a Computer Science and Information Technology student, I am developing my skills in AI/ML, software development, GitHub, backend development, and programming while building projects and participating in technical activities.

My goal is to bridge the gap between complex technologies and students who may feel intimidated by them. I want to learn from experienced developers and mentors while also sharing what I learn through technical tutorials, AI/ML learning content, workshops, and community activities. Programs such as Microsoft Student Ambassadors and GitHub Campus Experts would give me an opportunity to strengthen both my technical and communication skills while contributing to a wider technology community.

I also want to become more active in open source by making meaningful contributions, improving my GitHub history, and collaborating with developers outside my immediate academic environment. My experience with public repositories, project documentation, GitHub, the Smart India Hackathon, HackerRank, and personal projects gives me a foundation to build upon.

Through this pathway, I hope to turn curiosity into practical learning and help other students discover how technology can solve real-world problems. I want to grow not only as a developer but also as someone who can learn, communicate, collaborate, and create opportunities for others.